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Financing of the United Nations peacekeeping forces in the Middle East: United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 of the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Appropriation for 2024/25	\$536,808,200
Allotment for 2024/25	\$526,315,000
Expenditure for 2024/25	\$519,991,200
Unencumbered balance for 2024/25	\$16,817,000
Appropriation for 2025/26	\$552,841,800
Projected expenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$467,366,100
Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$85,475,700
Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27	\$408,023,700
Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	(\$398,700)
Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	\$407,625,000

^a Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

^b Excludes one-time requirements for the termination entitlements payable to staff members.



I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the report of the Secretary-General on the financing of the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) (A/80/634), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses received on 31 March 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report (A/80/604), and those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report (A/80/633).

II. Budget performance report for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. By its resolution 78/305, the General Assembly appropriated an amount of \$536,808,200 gross (\$518,691,300 net) for the maintenance of the Force for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. A total allotment was issued to the Force in the amount of \$526,315,000 (or 98.0 per cent of the appropriation). Expenditure for the period totalled \$519,991,200 gross (\$503,097,700 net), with a budget implementation rate of 96.9 per cent, which reflects: (a) lower-than-budgeted expenditure under military and police personnel; (b) higher-than-budgeted expenditure under civilian personnel; and (c) lower-than-budgeted expenditure under operational costs.

3. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that redeployments in the amount of \$8,137,100 to group II (civilian personnel) resulted from excess expenditures due to higher common staff costs, relating to relocation, hardship and non-family duty station allowances, and danger pay. The Committee was informed that the positive balances under group I (military and police personnel) were attributable primarily to the delayed, non- or partial deployment of contingent-owned equipment and the higher actual average vacancy rate, while under group III (operational costs), the savings were attributable primarily to the curtailed acquisition of prefabricated facilities and lower costs for air operations during the continued exchange of fire across the Blue Line.

4. According to information provided to the Advisory Committee, during the 2024/25 period, movement restrictions and the volatile security environment meant that critical activities could not be safely implemented, including as a result of reduced access along certain sectors of the Blue Line, delayed supply convoys, the postponement of minor infrastructure works, deferred procurement and limited training and programmatic engagements. The mission also absorbed additional expenditures amounting to \$20.2 million due to the security situation, comprising (a) military and police personnel (\$1.7 million) for additional combat rations and expanded capabilities for the clearance and disposal of explosive and counter-improvised explosive devices; (b) civilian personnel (\$17.7 million) for the introduction of allowances related to the hardship classification and non-family status of the duty station, security evacuation allowance and early separation for participating staff members; and (c) operational costs (\$0.7 million) for emergency engineering works, additional vehicle operating and fuel costs due to security-related movement, increased readiness to address medical needs, and freight-related transport. **The Advisory Committee notes that expenditures in the 2024/25 period were significantly affected by the volatile security environment, including movement restrictions, which led to redeployments from group I and III to group II.**

5. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that, as at 30 June 2025, unliquidated obligations for 2024/25 amounted to \$67,893,500 (or 12.6 per cent of the appropriation), comprising military and police personnel (\$54,042,800), civilian personnel (\$2,489,400) and operational costs (\$11,361,300), which represented a decrease of \$13,309,600 compared with the amount of \$81,203,100 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, unliquidated obligations had decreased to \$7,079,500 (or 1.3 per cent of the total appropriation) for the 2024/25 period, comprising military and police personnel (\$2,426,800), civilian personnel (\$32,000) and operational costs (\$4,620,700). **The Advisory Committee notes the decrease in unliquidated obligations and trusts that more information thereon, in particular on those resulting from commitments made towards year-end, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report. In view of the mission's upcoming closure, the Committee further trusts that unliquidated obligations will continue to be reduced and that new obligations will be incurred prudently so as to avoid the accumulation of unliquidated balances.** The Committee further discusses the management of unliquidated obligations in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

6. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that, for the period 2021/22, the cancellation of prior-period obligations amounted to \$1,378,200 (comprising \$1,191,500 for group I, \$19,000 for group II and \$167,700 for group III) and \$1,060,300 (comprising \$790,500 for group I, \$700 for group II and \$269,100 for group III) for the period 2022/23. For military and police personnel, the cancellations were mainly attributable to the delayed deployment and non-deployment of military contingent personnel and equipment and to cancellation of commitments for rations owing to a technical issue in Umoja. For operational costs, the cancellations were mainly attributable to delays in construction projects and the subsequent prolonged procurement process that was overtaken by the security situation. **The Advisory Committee notes that the cancellation of prior-period commitments decreased from \$1,378,200 for the period 2021/22 and \$1,060,300 for the period 2022/23. The Committee notes, however, the increase in the cancellation of prior-period obligations under operational costs.** The Committee further discusses the cancellation of prior-period obligations in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

7. The unencumbered balance, in gross terms, amounts to \$16,817,000, or 3.1 per cent of the overall level of resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General. Information provided to the Advisory Committee indicates that other revenue and adjustments for the 2024/25 period amount to \$15,915,400, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$10,727,400); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$464,700); and (c) the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$4,723,300). The Committee notes that the Secretary-General, in paragraph 119 of his report, proposes that credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments be placed in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates (see para. 56 below).

8. The Secretary-General indicates that UNIFIL issued loans to five other peacekeeping missions between 31 July 2024 and 30 June 2025 and that the status of the loan balance of UNIFIL as a lending entity amounted to \$78.4 million as at 30 June 2025 ([A/80/634](#), para. 74). Information contained in the report of the Board of Auditors ([A/80/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), para. 216) indicates that, since the closure of the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali, UNIFIL has

become one of the main sources of funding for inter-mission loans and, as at 30 June 2025, had contributed a total of 40 per cent of inter-mission loans.

Matters pertaining to the report of the Board of Auditors

9. In considering the report of the Secretary-General, the Advisory Committee also had before it the report of the Board of Auditors on the accounts of the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2025 (A/80/5 (Vol. II)). Regarding UNIFIL, the Board noted issues in terms of inventory increases, the significant redeployments made from group III to groups I and II, and variances of -18.7 per cent under group III expenditures (ibid., chap. II, para. 247, and chap. IV, para. 21). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the recommendations of the Board of Auditors will be implemented in a timely manner.**

III. Information on performance for the current period

10. Regarding current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$292,222,300, or 52.9 per cent of the appropriation of \$552,841,800. At the end of the current period, the estimated total expenditure would amount to \$467,366,100,¹ representing an implementation rate of 84.5 per cent of the appropriation.

11. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNIFIL had implemented a 15 per cent reduction in expenditure for the 2025/26 period, in accordance with the contingency plan. The contingency plan addressed liquidity constraints that impacted the 2025/26 period, while simultaneously ensuring continuity of mission cohesion, critical capabilities, operational credibility, mandate delivery and the safety and security of peacekeepers. Implementation measures included the repatriation of military personnel, contingent-owned equipment and maritime assets, consolidation and transfer of seven United Nations positions to the Lebanese Armed Forces and a civilian staff recruitment freeze and early separation programmes, which resulted in 227 vacancies for civilian posts. Furthermore, the plan also included the suspension of asset replacement, cancellation of the prefabricated facilities conversion plan and hard-wall construction projects, and the curtailment of training, travel and other discretionary expenditure.

12. **The Advisory Committee notes that UNIFIL has applied a structured, risk-informed prioritization process that first protects minimum operating requirements considered to be non-discretionary while simultaneously ensuring mandate delivery and the safety and security of peacekeepers. The Committee trusts that an update and a more detailed assessment on the impact of the contingency plan on the implementation of the mandate by UNIFIL will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the report and in the next performance report. The Committee also trusts that all efforts will be undertaken to ensure the security and safety of personnel.**

13. The Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 17 February 2026, a total of \$13,186,562,000 had been assessed on Member States in respect of UNIFIL since its inception. Payments received as at the same date amounted to \$12,938,155,000, leaving an outstanding balance of \$248,407,000. As at 27 March 2026, the cash available amounted to \$244,162,258. After its lending of \$150,400,000, the mission's remaining cash on hand amounted to \$93,762,258, which was sufficient to cover the

¹ Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

three-month operating reserve of \$64,482,625 (excluding reimbursements to troop- and police-contributing countries).

14. The Advisory Committee notes from the information provided to it that, as at 31 December 2025, the outstanding balance for troop costs and contingent-owned equipment amounted to \$39,819,000 and \$97,622,000, respectively. As at the same date, \$26,101,000 had been paid to settle 403 death and disability claims since the inception of the Force, with 15 claims amounting to \$175,000 pending. **The Advisory Committee trusts that all outstanding liabilities and claims will be settled expeditiously, particularly in the light of the upcoming closure of the Force.**

IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

A. Mandate and planning assumptions

15. The mandate of UNIFIL was established by the Security Council in its resolutions [425 \(1978\)](#) and [426 \(1978\)](#) and was most recently extended by the Council in its resolution [2790 \(2025\)](#), by which it extended the mandate for a final time until 31 December 2026, when the Force is to cease its operations and to start from this date and within one year complete its orderly and safe drawdown and withdrawal of personnel ([A/80/634](#), para. 1). The planning assumptions and mission support initiatives of UNIFIL for the 2026/27 period are summarized in section I.C of the report of the Secretary-General.

Period of regular mandated operations from 1 July to 31 December 2026

16. The Secretary-General indicates that UNIFIL will, during the first six months of the 2026/27 period, prioritize activities aimed at supporting the parties in maintaining the cessation of hostilities and stability along the Blue Line, recommitting to the full implementation of Security Council resolution [1701 \(2006\)](#) and taking concrete steps towards addressing outstanding provisions of the resolution, including steps towards a permanent ceasefire, and a long-term political solution between Lebanon and Israel. UNIFIL will also support relevant enhanced diplomatic efforts to resolve any dispute or reservations pertaining to the international border between Lebanon and Israel, pursuant to resolution [2790 \(2025\)](#) (*ibid.*, para. 16).

Drawdown and withdrawal period from 1 January to 30 June 2027

17. The Secretary-General indicates that, on 31 December 2026, UNIFIL will cease its operations and then begin and within one year complete the orderly and safe drawdown and withdrawal of its personnel as from 1 January 2027, in close consultation with the Government of Lebanon, with the aim of making the Government the sole provider of security in southern Lebanon, and in coordination with the troop-contributing countries. During the drawdown and withdrawal period, and in line with established financial regulations and rules of the United Nations, UNIFIL will take all necessary steps to ensure that property and assets are safely transferred to the control of the designated entity (*ibid.*, para. 24).

18. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, by the final stage of the drawdown, 1,037 military personnel and 464 civilian staff would be retained as at 30 June 2027 in order to complete the last elements of consolidation and withdrawal, the repatriation of contingent- and United Nations-owned equipment, site closure, administrative closeout and pre-liquidation activities. This configuration reflects the mission closure plan, the drawdown sequencing, activities mandated by Security

Council resolution [2790 \(2025\)](#) (paras. 5 and 6) and the progressive reduction of tasks following the cessation of mandated operations on 31 December 2026. UNIFIL also anticipates specialized support from the Secretariat after 1 July 2027 as part of the 2027/28 liquidation period, which would be included in the proposed budget for that period. The withdrawal phase includes \$52.7 million in one-time costs for the repatriation of contingent-owned equipment, staff separation and limited surge support. These resources will enable an accelerated withdrawal while ensuring the safety and security of personnel and operational control.

19. The Advisory Committee was also informed that, pursuant to the request contained in Security Council resolution [2790 \(2025\)](#) that the Secretary-General explore options for the future of the implementation of resolution [1701 \(2006\)](#), by 1 June 2026, the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and the Department of Peace Operations were developing options, in consultation with Member States and relevant United Nations entities, for the consideration of the Secretary-General, who will share proposals with the Security Council no later than 1 June 2026. The Committee was also informed that, without prejudice to the options presented by the Secretary-General, UNIFIL, the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon and the United Nations country team are coordinating to ensure a smooth transition of relevant functions in 2027. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the options for the future of the implementation of Security Council resolution [1701 \(2006\)](#) will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Operational constraints

20. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the 2026/27 budget proposal and its withdrawal timeline was based on the assumption of permissive security conditions, which is the only scenario under which a six-month drawdown is operationally feasible. Drawing on lessons learned from previous mission closures, UNIFIL adopted a time-bound, conditions-informed approach, in which sequencing and tempo remain adjustable should operational circumstances change. Contingency triggers identified by UNIFIL include a re-escalation of hostilities; a deterioration of domestic stability affecting freedom of movement; logistical constraints affecting convoy routing or asset consolidation; and liquidity constraints that could delay repatriation or separation payments. Should such conditions arise, UNIFIL will adjust the pace and sequencing of drawdown activities, prioritize critical operational and security requirements, and defer non-essential tasks in coordination with United Nations Headquarters. Regional volatility remains a key planning risk; however, the proposed budget reflects conservative, risk-informed assumptions and retains essential enabling capacities for force protection, logistics and movement control. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the operational environment of the Force, including any possible implications for the withdrawal timeline and the budgetary requirements for the 2026/27 period, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

Lessons learned from past mission closures

21. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, drawing on lessons from previous mission closures, UNIFIL had established integrated planning arrangements and had adopted a phased approach to the drawdown, ensuring close internal coordination and continuous liaison with the host Government. The planning framework encompasses capability-based military sequencing, progressive footprint consolidation and early asset verification and disposal. Coordination with the Office of the United Nations Special Coordinator for Lebanon and other United Nations

partners further supports continuity of engagement, while the availability of functioning national airspace and seaports facilitates predictable and efficient logistical operations. Taken together, these measures are intended to ensure an orderly and safe drawdown and withdrawal in accordance with Security Council resolution 2790 (2025). **The Advisory Committee trusts that all the lessons learned from past mission closures will be fully taken into account in both the planning and the implementation of the drawdown and withdrawal of UNIFIL, particularly in relation to asset disposal, flexibility in planning and early engagement with United Nations Headquarters, the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy, and the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda.**

Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency

22. The Advisory Committee notes that, for the 2026/27 period, UNIFIL is not indicating any efficiency gains, as shown in section II.C of the report of the Secretary-General. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, in line with the Secretary-General's UN80 Initiative principles, the cost estimates for 2026/27 reflect operational adjustments derived from the contingency plan, whereby, starting 1 July 2026, the proposed budget includes resources for the reduced troop strength of 7,372 and civilian staffing of 621 posts and positions following the abolishment of 227 vacant posts. The liquidity measures implemented in the 2025/26 period have not affected the ability of UNIFIL to implement its mandate through December 2026 or to complete the necessary preparations for withdrawal. The Committee was also informed that additional cost containment measures include the cancellation of construction projects and equipment acquisition plans, as well as accelerated force consolidation, including through the reduction of approximately 1,000 troops and the closure or transfer of six positions on a monthly basis. With these structural adjustments, UNIFIL is able to maintain essential operational capabilities and subsequently draw down, resulting in a 26.2 per cent reduction in the proposed resource requirements for 2026/27. **The Advisory Committee notes that proposed reductions for UNIFIL are related to the implementation of Security Council resolution 2790 (2025) and the mandate for an orderly and safe drawdown and withdrawal of personnel starting in January 2027. The Committee further notes that, accordingly, no reductions are presented by the mission as efficiency gains.**

B. Resource requirements

23. The total resource requirements in the amount of \$408,023,700 for the period 2026/27 represent a decrease of \$144,818,100, or 26.2 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$552,841,800 for 2025/26. Information on variances between the apportionment for 2025/26 and the proposed resources for 2026/27 is contained in section III of the proposed budget.

Financial resources

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Approved (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
Military and police personnel	350 857.2	336 134.4	350 947.3	179 387.6	259 142.9	(91 804.4)	(26.2)
Civilian personnel	131 255.9	139 393.0	149 214.8	92 023.5	114 979.8	(34 235.0)	(22.9)
Operational costs	54 695.1	44 463.8	52 679.7	20 811.2	33 901.0	(18 778.7)	(35.6)
Gross requirements	536 808.2	519 991.2	552 841.8	292 222.3	408 023.7	(144 818.1)	(26.2)

24. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the proposed budget broken down into two six-month periods for the 2026/27 period. For military and police personnel, the proposed resources for the first six-month period amount to \$206,321,175, while the resources for the second six-month period amount to \$201,702,532. For civilian personnel and operational costs, the proposed resources for the first six-month period amount to \$53,788,000 and \$21,021,777, respectively, while resources for the second six-month period amount to \$61,191,800 and \$12,879,207, respectively. **The Advisory Committee considers that, in cases such as UNIFIL, in which a single budget period encompasses requirements related to distinct stages of the mission's life cycle, such as start-up, steady state and drawdown and liquidation, the budget submission should clearly disaggregate resource requirements for each stage to enhance the transparency and accuracy of the assessment of resource needs. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly request the Secretary-General to ensure such disaggregation in future budget submissions, as appropriate.**

1. Military and police personnel

Category	Authorized 2024/25 ^a	Actual 2024/25	Authorized 2025/26 ^a	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average as at 28 February 2026	Projected 2026/27	
						Operational period (1 July to 31 December 2026)	Drawdown and withdrawal period (as at 30 June 2027)
Military contingent personnel	13 000	9 762	13 000	7 574	9 023	7 372	1 037

^a Represents the highest level of authorized strength.

Delayed deployment factors

(Percentage of approved strength)

Category	Authorized 2024/25	Actual 2024/25	Authorized 2025/26	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average as at 28 February 2026	Projected 2026/27	
						Operational period (1 July to 31 December 2026)	Drawdown and withdrawal period (as at 30 June 2027)
Military and police personnel							
Military contingents	24.2	23.5	24.2	41.7	30.6	N/A	N/A

Abbreviation: N/A, not applicable.

25. The proposed resources for military and police personnel for 2026/27 amount to \$259,142,900, representing a decrease of \$91,804,400, or 26.2 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$350,947,300 for 2025/26. The decrease is attributable primarily to lower costs for standard troop cost reimbursement, allowances, rations and contingent-owned equipment and contingent marine operations owing to operational adjustments and the repatriation of military contingents as from January 2027 in accordance with the Force's integrated drawdown and withdrawal plan, offset in part by higher costs for freight for the corresponding repatriation of contingent-owned equipment (*ibid.*, para. 88).

26. The Secretary-General proposes the deployment of 7,372 military personnel (7,199 military contingent personnel and 173 military staff officers) during the operational period from 1 July to 31 Dec 2026. During the drawdown and withdrawal period, which covers 1 January to 30 June 2027, it is proposed to retain up to 1,037 military personnel (964 military contingent personnel and 73 military staff officers). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, of the 9,851 approved

military personnel, 2,277 had already been repatriated as at 28 February and 7,372 had been costed for six months (July-December 2026) based on the assumption of a permissive environment, after which a number of troops would be drawn down each month and costed accordingly (January: 7,372; February: 6,568; March: 5,885; April: 4,581; May: 3,283; and June: 1,689). This approach is equivalent to applying a 52.8 per cent vacancy rate in the calculation of military personnel requirements.

27. With regard to the repatriation of troops, the Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that a consolidation and repatriation plan would be implemented as from 1 January 2027. The withdrawal sequence would primarily be capability-driven, while rotation calendars would serve as a secondary consideration. While the withdrawal plan takes into account the rotation cycles of troop-contributing countries' infantry units to the extent possible while ensuring systematic consolidation from positions along the Blue Line to battalion and sector headquarters, key enablers, such as engineering, medical, explosive ordnance disposal, mobility and communications, are retained until the later stages of the process. However, rotational schedules fall primarily in the drawdown and withdrawal period. The projected residual strength of 1,037 personnel as at 30 June 2027 represents a capability-based end-state required to ensure Force protection, site consolidation, convoy security, processing of contingent-owned equipment, asset safeguarding and environmental remediation, rather than the operational requirements projected for the preceding six-month mandate period.

28. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for military and police personnel.**

2. Civilian personnel

Category	Approved 2024/25	Encumbered as at 30 June 2025	Approved 2025/26	Encumbered as at 28 February 2026	Proposed 2026/27		Variance
					Operational period (1 July to 31 December 2026)	Drawdown and withdrawal period (as at 30 June 2027)	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)=(6)-(3)
Posts							
International staff	254	241	253	206	202	155	(98)
National staff							
National Professional Officers	46	43	46	40	40	24	(22)
National General Service staff	544	502	544	381	375	283	(261)
United Nations Volunteers							
International	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
National	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
General temporary assistance							
International staff	1	1	1	1	1	1	—
National General Service staff	4	4	4	3	3	1	(3)
Government-provided personnel	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Total	849	791	848	631	621	464	(384)

29. The proposed resources for civilian personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$114,979,800, reflecting a decrease of \$34,235,000 (or 22.9 per cent) compared with the apportionment of \$149,214,800 for 2025/26. The reduced requirements are attributable mainly to the abolishment of 98 international posts, 22 National Professional Officer posts and 261 national General Service posts in accordance with

the Force's operational adjustment and integrated drawdown and withdrawal plan, as well as the application of a lower revised post adjustment multiplier rate for international staff, offset in part by requirements for common staff costs for separation and repatriation entitlements, and other personnel costs for support functions such as surge capacity, estimated on the basis of 22 positions (*ibid.*, paras. 90–96).

Recommendations on posts and positions

30. The Secretary-General proposes a total of 621 civilian staff for the period 1 July to 31 December 2026, comprising 202 international staff, 415 national staff (40 National Professional Officer and 375 national General Service staff), and 4 general temporary assistance positions. For the period 1 January to 30 June 2027, the Secretary-General proposes a total of 551 civilian staff, comprising 177 international staff, 370 national staff (34 National Professional Officer and 336 national General Service staff) and 4 general temporary assistance positions. As at 30 June 2027, a total of 464 civilian staff are proposed to be retained, comprising 155 international staff, 307 national staff (24 National Professional Officer and 283 national General Service staff) and 2 general temporary assistance positions. The changes reflect a net decrease of 381 posts and 3 positions.

Abolishment

31. The Secretary-General proposes the abolishment of 226 posts (2 D-1, 8 P-4, 7 P-3, 34 Field Service, 6 National Professional Officer and 170 national General Service) and 1 general temporary assistance position, all of which are currently vacant, during the operational period effective as from 1 July 2026. Another 155 posts and 2 positions are proposed to be abolished during the drawdown and withdrawal period, as follows: (a) 70 posts (2 D-2, 5 P-5, 6 P-4, 4 P-3, 2 P-2/1, 6 Field Service, 6 National Professional Officer and 39 national General Service), effective as at 31 December 2026; and (b) 85 posts (2 D-1, 2 P-4, 1 P-3, 17 Field Service, 10 National Professional Officer and 55 national General Service) and 2 positions, effective as at 30 June 2027.

32. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, at the end of the 2026/27 period, a total of 462 posts and 2 positions would be retained for the remainder of the drawdown and withdrawal period in 2027/28. The Committee was also informed that the retention of the 464 civilian personnel was aligned with the functions required after mandated operations cease on 31 December 2026 to support the administrative, logistical and financial aspects of the final drawdown and pre-liquidation period. **The Advisory Committee notes that while military personnel will be repatriated in a phased manner during the drawdown and withdrawal period (see para. 26 above), all civilian personnel who will be retained as at 1 January 2027 will remain until 30 June 2027, and trusts that the necessity of and justification for retaining the same number of staff will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

Common staff costs

33. Upon enquiry, the Advisory committee was informed that an estimated amount of \$11.7 million was included in the proposed budget for 2026/27 to cover statutory separation obligations arising from the abolishment of posts and positions during the period, in accordance with the applicable Staff Regulations and Staff Rules of the United Nations. The estimated costs are distributed as follows: international staff, \$9.7 million; National Professional Officer, \$0.3 million; General Service staff, \$1.7 million. **The Advisory Committee trusts that future reports will include detailed information comparing the estimated and actual expenditures of**

separation costs, as well as information on UNIFIL staff who were not ultimately separated because they were appointed to other posts within the Organization and on those who were reinstated or re-employed by the Organization within 12 months of their separation.

Separating national staff

34. With regard to the assistance provided to separating staff members, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNIFIL has 11 courses specifically designed to assist national civilian staff in transitioning and preparing for life after the closure of the mission. These courses are focused on career development, entrepreneurship, financial planning and job application skills for external labour markets. **The Advisory Committee recalls that the General Assembly recognized the importance of capacity-building for national staff in the drawdown phases of missions (see Assembly resolutions 69/259 B, 69/258 B and 67/277) and trusts that the Secretary-General will continue his efforts in this regard and will provide an update in the next report.**

General temporary assistance

35. The Secretary-General proposes resources amounting to \$2,938,700, reflecting an increase of \$2,200,400 (298 per cent) compared with the apportionment of \$738,300 for 2025/26. The increased requirements are attributable primarily to other personnel costs to provide for an estimated surge capacity of 22 positions (11 international (5 P-3 and 6 Field Service) and 11 national General Service). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the surge capacity would support the mission's operations in the final months of the mandate. For instance, as locations close and staffing levels decrease, the mission will experience a temporary and acute surge in workload in areas such as logistical support, property verification, warehouse consolidation, human resources separations, contract closure, final payments, environmental assessments, engineering inspections and movement coordination at varied stages. The surge capacity would sustain continuity of operations until workloads decline and functions contract, whereas maintaining fixed posts for short-term peak demands would create long-term liabilities and misalign staffing with the structural needs of the UNIFIL withdrawal period.

Vacant posts

36. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, 217 posts (2 D-1, 1 P-5, 6 P-4, 6 P-3, 32 Field Service, 6 National Professional Officer and 163 national General Service) were vacant, of which 24 posts had been vacant for more than two years. All vacant posts as at 28 February were proposed for abolishment at 1 July 2026, except for one Senior Public Information Officer (P-5) and one Movement Control Assistant (national General Service). **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the number of vacant posts and their recruitment status will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission. The Committee considers that all vacant posts not under active recruitment should be abolished and trusts that updated information in that regard will be provided to the Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report.**

37. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, 16 posts (14 Field Service and 2 national General Service) were encumbered by staff with approved request for the early separation programme. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on all staff of the Force approved for the early separation programme, as well as on the related cost will**

be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.

Vacancy rates

(Percentage)

Category	Budgeted 2024/25	Actual 2024/25	Budgeted 2025/26	Actual average, January– December 2025	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average July 2025– February 2026	Proposed 2026/27
Civilian personnel							
International staff	3.5	5.5	3.9	8.3	18.6	12.3	N/A
National staff							
National Professional Officers	2.2	6.5	4.3	8.7	13.0	10.9	N/A
National General Service staff	5.9	7.7	7.2	13.1	30.0	21.1	N/A
United Nations Volunteers							
International	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
National	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
General temporary assistance							
International staff	–	–	–	–	–	–	N/A
National General Service staff	50.0	25.0	25.0	25.0	25.0	25.0	N/A
Government-provided personnel	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Abbreviation: N/A, not applicable.

38. Upon enquiry, with respect to the non-application of vacancy rates for civilian personnel in the proposed 2026/27 budget, the Advisory Committee was informed that, owing to the proposed abolishment of the 384 post and positions, historical vacancy rates no longer provided a relevant basis for cost estimates. Furthermore, the proposed abolishment of the posts and positions in a phased manner in line with the mission's operational adjustments is equivalent to applying a 30.9 per cent vacancy rate in the calculation of civilian staff requirements. **The Advisory Committee is of the view that it is unrealistic to assume that all proposed 621 civilian personnel will remain until 31 December 2026 and that all proposed 551 civilian personnel will remain until 30 June 2027 and trusts that the Secretary-General will provide to the General Assembly additional clarification of and justification for the assumption in comparison with previous incumbency levels at times of drawdown and liquidation of other missions at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

39. Subject to its recommendations in paragraphs 36 and 38 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian personnel.

3. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)	(7)=(6)÷(3)
Civilian electoral observers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Consultants and consulting services	88.3	110.6	226.0	31.5	185.7	(40.3)	(17.8)
Official travel	721.3	880.5	713.7	502.4	493.3	(220.4)	(30.9)
Facilities and infrastructure	28 147.5	20 427.3	24 813.5	9 922.1	15 927.7	(8 885.8)	(35.8)
Ground transportation	6 546.4	7 196.0	5 775.5	3 132.2	4 370.2	(1 405.3)	(24.3)
Air operations	5 929.9	4 007.9	5 412.6	2 941.3	4 955.8	(456.8)	(8.4)
Marine operations	172.1	17.8	56.3	12.9	25.0	(31.3)	(55.6)
Communications and information technology	8 036.9	7 326.0	9 896.2	2 929.2	4 089.6	(5 806.6)	(58.7)
Medical	1 323.4	962.6	1 484.9	490.1	932.4	(552.5)	(37.2)
Special equipment	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Other supplies, services and equipment	3 229.3	3 035.1	3 301.0	449.8	2 571.3	(729.7)	(22.1)
Quick-impact projects	500.0	500.0	1 000.0	399.7	350.0	(650.0)	(65.0)
Total	54 695.1	44 463.8	52 679.7	20 811.2	33 901.0	(18 778.7)	(35.6)

40. The proposed requirements of \$33,901,000 reflect a decrease of \$18,778,700, or 35.6 per cent, compared with the resources approved for 2025/26. The proposed decrease reflects reduced requirements under all budget classes ([A/80/634](#), sects. II and IV).

41. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNIFIL had suspended, and later discontinued, discretionary procurement of equipment, materials and supplies, in line with liquidity constraints during the 2025/26 period and with the subsequent Security Council resolution [2790 \(2025\)](#). Procurement is restricted to essential, short-term and non-discretionary requirements necessary to sustain operations through to 31 December 2026 and to support subsequent drawdown and withdrawal activities. The five-year asset replacement plan, construction projects and non-essential acquisitions of, inter alia, vehicles, computers and other information and communications technology (ICT) equipment were discontinued. The Committee was also informed that items identified as surplus were recorded and flagged in Umoja for redeployment within the United Nations system, in coordination with the Global Asset Management Policy Service and the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy. Furthermore, as mandated operations are continuing to 31 December 2026, detailed planning has been under way to progressively transfer surplus assets to other United Nations entities during the drawdown phase, thereby minimizing new contractual commitments, avoiding unnecessary asset accumulation prior to closure and maximizing the system-wide utilization of resources.

Official travel

42. The proposed resources amount to \$493,300, reflecting a decrease of \$220,400 (30.9 per cent) compared with the apportionment of \$713,700 (\$509,700 for non-training travel and \$204,000 for training travel) for 2025/26. The proposed resources for non-training travel amount to \$394,100, a decrease of 16.8 per cent, and \$99,200 for training travel, a decrease of 51.4 per cent compared with the

apportionments for 2025/26. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the proposed resources for non-training travel for the first six-month maintenance period amount to \$383,858, which is a more than 50 per cent increase compared with half of the apportionment for non-training official travel in 2025/26. **The Advisory Committee emphasizes that greater use of on-the-job training, virtual meetings, online platforms and online training tools should be made and reiterates its view that travel for conferences, workshops and professional meetings should be kept to a minimum in order to achieve efficiencies. The Committee is also of the view that the reduction in the number of staff and the start of the drawdown period from January 2027 should have resulted in a commensurate adjustment in the estimated requirements for travel, and therefore recommends a reduction of 20 per cent (or \$98,700) to the proposed resources for official travel.**

Facilities and infrastructure

43. The proposed resources amount to \$15,927,700, reflecting a decrease of \$8,885,800 (35.8 per cent) compared with the apportionment for 2025/26. For 2024/25, expenditure amounted to \$20,427,300 against an appropriation of \$28,147,500, and in 2023/24, expenditure amounted to \$20,402,900 against \$26,670,500. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as UNIFIL has suspended all plans for new infrastructure construction, there were currently no ongoing construction or infrastructure projects. For the 2026/27 period, the planned projects that have been discontinued amount to \$4,403,358, inclusive of the prefabricated facilities conversion plan (\$3,897,558) and the conversion of some UNIFIL facilities from canvas tents to hardwall structures (\$309,100). Reduced requirements are offset in part by increased requirements for utilities and waste disposal services to support the closure of positions and the removal of masts and all associated field technology infrastructure. The Committee notes that, despite proposed reductions, requirements for the acquisition of engineering supplies, of prefabricated facilities, accommodation and refrigeration equipment and of generators and electrical equipment still amount to \$367,700, \$220,500 and \$215,300, respectively, for the 2026/27 period. The Committee also notes, with regard to maintenance services, that the proposed resources amount to \$1,554,000, comprising \$886,000 for the period 1 June to 31 December 2026 and \$668,000 for the period 1 January to 30 June 2027. For 2024/25, expenditure totalled \$1,122,700 against \$1,578,600. **In the light of the reduced footprint in connection to the drawdown and withdrawal of UNIFIL, and considering that all new infrastructure construction projects have been suspended and that asset acquisition should be limited to minimum requirements at this stage, the Advisory Committee recommends a reduction of 5 per cent (or \$300,000) to proposed resources under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol, oil and lubricants.**

Petrol, oil and lubricants

44. A total provision of \$13,554,585 is proposed for fuel, oil and lubricants for the 2026/27 period, reflecting a decrease of \$2,663,565, or 16.4 per cent, due mainly to changes in fuel costs under facilities and infrastructure, ground transportation and air operations and to lower estimated required litres of fuel under facilities and infrastructure and ground transportation during the budget period. The Committee notes that the estimated litres required for 2026/27 total 15,123,984 litres compared to the 18,365,368 litres approved for 2025/26 and the actual consumption of 17,302,197 litres in 2024/25. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.** The Committee discusses fuel costs and management in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

45. Subject to the recommendations contained in paragraphs 42 and 43 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.

V. Other matters

Safety and security of United Nations personnel

46. With respect to the ongoing security situation, the Advisory Committee notes two incidents in March 2026 that affected the safety and security of United Nations personnel, equipment and installations in UNIFIL, resulting in the death of three peacekeepers and injuries to three others. **The Advisory Committee expresses its concern regarding the threat to life and to the safety and security of UNIFIL personnel. The Committee pays tribute to all UNIFIL personnel who have lost their lives or have been injured in the service of peace.**

Damages to UNIFIL installations and assets

47. The Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that all incidents involving damage to United Nations-owned equipment or contingent-owned equipment had been fully recorded and assessed after a formal investigation to establish the facts, determine attribution and assess whether the incident constituted a violation of Security Council resolution 1701 (2006). UNIFIL reports all such incidents to the Security Council through the Secretary-General's periodic reports on the implementation of Council resolution 1701 (2006). At the same time, in line with United Nations policy and past practice, these assessments are maintained for accountability and audit purposes. However, compensation or claims processes related to those damages sustained by UNIFIL installations have not been initiated. Upon further enquiry, the Committee was informed that claims for damages to contingent-owned equipment may be submitted by the Permanent Mission of the troop-contributing country in accordance with the Contingent-Owned Equipment Manual and are subject to validation in accordance with applicable board of inquiry standard operating procedure. United Nations-owned equipment is evaluated and written off in accordance with the applicable Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations. Receivables require a formally established and enforceable obligation, typically arising from a decision of the General Assembly or other intergovernmental mechanism. In the absence of such obligation, no receivable is recorded. **The Advisory Committee trusts that further information, including on financial damages recorded by UNIFIL, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Qana incident

48. The Secretary-General indicates that, pursuant to requests made by the General Assembly in its relevant resolutions with regard to payment of the amount of \$1,117,005 resulting from the incident at Qana on 18 April 1996, the Secretariat had transmitted 31 letters to the Permanent Mission of Israel on the subject, the most recent of which was dated 30 December 2025, to which no response had been received (A/80/634, para. 86). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the amount, which has been recorded under accounts receivable in the special account for UNIFIL, will remain a legally valid receivable even after the closure of UNIFIL. Any reporting on follow-up of the obligation would be continued, including through subsequent UNIFIL reports and, ultimately, in the financial statements for peacekeeping operations, as appropriate. **The Advisory Committee notes that the**

amount has been recorded under accounts receivable in the special account for UNIFIL and will remain a legally valid receivable after the closure of UNIFIL. The Committee trusts that the matter will continue to be presented to the General Assembly so that the Assembly remains duly seized of the matter. The Committee trusts that updated information will be provided in the next budget submission and in future reports.

Environmental initiatives

49. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNIFIL will implement a comprehensive environmental remediation programme as part of its drawdown and site-closure activities. For each location being vacated, the mission conducts environmental close-out assessments and, where required, mitigation measures, such as soil remediation, spill cleanup, removal and disposal of contaminated or hazardous materials, decontamination of infrastructure, restoration of disturbed areas and the safe decommissioning of wastewater and fuel systems, would be implemented. All actions are documented and entail continual inspections and verification to ensure that the sites meet environmental standards prior to closure or transfer to the host authorities. The Committee was also informed that the environmental activities are planned and sequenced in line with the closure schedule and are subject to monitoring and quality assurance to ensure full compliance and cost control. **The Advisory Committee notes the measures to be taken during the liquidation phase to ensure an environmentally compliant handover of the UNIFIL compounds to the national authorities and trusts that any lessons learned from the liquidation of other field missions will be applied in UNIFIL drawdown and withdrawal.** The Committee further discusses environmental activities and energy efficiency in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

Regional mission cooperation and other services provided on a cost-recovery basis by UNIFIL

50. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that these services would remain operational through 30 June 2027. Discussions regarding the future of the services are ongoing and are being coordinated with Headquarters, the United Nations Global Service Centre/United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy, the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe and relevant receiving entities. For example, responsibilities related to the Regional Field Technology Service for region 1 are planned to be shifted to region 2, in Entebbe, with structured overlap to ensure knowledge transfer, documentation handover and service continuity. Similarly, functions such as HIV/AIDS coordination, conduct and discipline, and ICT advisory roles are being reviewed at Headquarters to determine their appropriate regional placement, ensuring that no gaps emerge during or after the transition.

51. Upon enquiry, in the context of its review of the proposed budget for the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, the Advisory Committee was informed that, of the entities that previously received support services from the Kuwait Joint Support Office, UNIFIL, the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi and the United Nations Disengagement Observer Force, as well as other special political missions, will receive only non-core services from the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe in 2026/27. The Committee makes further comments in its report on the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda ([A/80/604/Add.4](#)).

Management of sea containers

52. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNIFIL currently holds 875 containers, with 722 being used for warehousing and storage of supplies and 153 in stock. The containers serve as storage units for spare parts, engineering materials, tools, supplies and general warehouse stock. They are also utilized as workshops and contain equipment and technical assets. The Committee was also informed that the containers are also used to move generators and equipment between United Nations positions and can serve as temporary workshops in construction and work areas in the field. The Committee further discusses the management of containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

Equitable geographical representation and gender parity

53. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, UNIFIL comprised 648 staff at all levels. Among the 221 international staff, 73 nationalities were represented. Of the total 648 staff, 423 were men and 225 were women.²

54. As at 31 December 2025, international staff were from the following regional groups: African States (50); Asia-Pacific States (66); Eastern European States (37); Latin American and Caribbean States (9); and Western European and other States (51); as well as from the United States of America (7) and other (1).

55. **The Advisory Committee trusts that UNIFIL will further pursue its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity.** The Committee discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

VI. Conclusion

56. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNIFIL for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are indicated in section V of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/634](#)). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$16,817,000 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue amounting to \$15,915,400 from investment revenue (\$10,727,400), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$464,700) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$4,723,300) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

57. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNIFIL for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are indicated in section V of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/634](#)). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$398,700, from \$408,023,700 to \$407,625,000. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$407,625,000 for the maintenance of the**

² Detailed and updated information on nationalities represented in UNIFIL is available on the United Nations Secretariat Workforce Portal.

Force for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027. A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Committee with regard to the financing of UNIFIL for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in the table below.

Budgetary impact and financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

<i>Category</i>	<i>Paragraph number (present report)</i>	<i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>	<i>Financial implication (United States dollars)</i>
Operational costs			
Official travel	42	A reduction of 20 per cent in the proposed resources for official travel.	(98 700)
Facilities and infrastructure	43	A reduction of 5 per cent to proposed resources under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol, oil and lubricants.	(300 000)
Total			(398 700)